ARIZONA EARLY LEARNING STANDARDS

4th Edition

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SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT STANDARD

Social emotional development is the core of early care and education because it sets a firmfoundation on which all other learning will take place.

Children's emotional development is built into the architecture of their brains**.** Relationships that provide social, emotional, andphysical security promote and enhance a child's ability to learn and thrive.

To grow socially and emotionally, children need to develop an increasing capacity to experience, express, and gain self-controlover their emotions and social interactions. This development is enhanced by nurturing relationships and positive early learning experiences. A consistent, predictable, and engaging environment strengthens a child's confidence in approaching new challenges, interacting with others, and exploring their environment.

Established social-emotional skills have a significant, positive impact on a child's learning, particularly in **cognitive development**. It sets the foundation for life-long success. This Standard articulates the ways in which a child can demonstrate their understanding of themselves and others, form positive social relationships, and relate to the world at large. Well-developed, strong, social emotional skills are critical when a child encounters a stressful life challenge. Thesehardships may include neglect, trauma, poverty, cultural and language differences, bias, and disabilities.

The Social-Emotional Development Standard is organized into the following Strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Self-Awareness and Emotional Skills

- Concept 1: Self-Awareness
- Concept 2: Recognizes and Expresses Feelings
- Concept 3: Self-Regulation

Strand 2: Relationships and Skills

- Concept 1: Attachment
- Concept 2: Social Interactions
- Concept 3: Respect

Social Emotional Development Standard Definitions

Autonomy is the ability and desire to be in charge of oneself.[1]

Cognitive Development is the field of study which focuses on the child's ability to acquire new knowledge and skills.

Emotional Literacy is the ability to label emotions and regulate them in socially appropriate ways.[2]

Empathy is the ability to recognize, respond, and share in another's emotions, thoughts, or feelings.

Nature and Nurture refers to the influence of both environmental and genetic factors on development.

Secure Attachment leads to confidence and trust that children have with the individual responsible for their care. It is the framework within which children develop their growing ability to regulate emotions and behavior.

Self-Awareness is the ability to recognize and understand one's self as an individual.

Temperament refers to a term used to describe the manner in which a child approaches and reacts to the world. It is their personal "style".

[1] Riley, D., San Juan, R., Klinker, J., & Ramminger, A. (2008). Social & emotional development: Connecting science and practice in early childhood settings. St Paul MN. Red Leaf Press.
[2] Zambo, D. & Hansen, C.C. (2007). Child development through the eyes of children's authors: Using picture books to understand theory. London, England: Pearson.

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

Concept 1: Self-Awareness

The child demonstrates an awareness of self.

Children develop a sense of personal identity as they begin to recognize the characteristics that make them unique as individuals and to build self-esteem.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. **Demonstrates self-confidence.**
   - Acknowledges her own accomplishments and says, “I can hit the ball.”
   - Explains, “I’m learning how to take care of myself and my friends.”
   - Signs, “I can do it myself.”

b. **Makes personal preferences known to others.**
   - Chooses carrots over celery during mealtime.
   - Tells friends, “I don’t like that.”

c. **Demonstrates knowledge of self-identity/autonomy.**
   - Declares, “I’m the big brother,” while looking at a family picture.
   - Tells the teacher, “I’m at school while mommy is at work.”
   - Holds up three fingers and says, “I am this many.”

d. **Displays an awareness of similarities and differences between self and others.**
   - Says, “My hair is curly and yours is straight.”
   - Points to shirt and then to friend’s shirt, indicating that they are wearing the same color of shirt.

e. **Demonstrates developmentally appropriate cultural curiosity and responsiveness.**
   - Wonders about a friend’s seaweed snack and asks for a taste.
   - The group widens the story time circle to make room for the child and their wheelchair.
   - A guest speaker (parent) shares a storybook and song in their home language to the class.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

Concept 2: Recognizes and Expresses Feelings

The child recognizes and expresses feelings of self and others.

Children develop **emotional literacy** through the ability to identify and acknowledge their feelings and feelings of others through daily interactions.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. **Associates emotions with words, facial expressions, and body language.**
   - Describes the emotions of a character in a book.
   - Signs, “I am mad” when asked how they feel.

b. **Identifies, describes, and expresses their own feelings.**
   - Covers their eyes and says, “This is scary!” while listening to a story.
   - Says, “I am happy today because it’s my birthday!”

c. **Identifies and describes feelings of others.**
   - Approaches an adult and says, “That child is sad. They are crying.”
   - Says, “My mommy will be so excited to see my picture!”

d. **Expresses feelings of satisfaction in independent activities**
   - Independently peddles the tricycle with a smile on their face.
   - Displays their clay structure and says, “Look what I did!”

e. **Expresses empathy for others.**
   - Sees a friend crying and then gives the friend a hug.
   - Asks, “Are you ok?” after seeing a friend fall down.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

Concept 3: Self-Regulation

The child manages the expression of feelings, thoughts, impulses, and behaviors.

Young children develop self-control as they acquire the ability to regulate their impulses with decreasing support fromadults. This enables children to function successfully and independently in both personal and social contexts. **Temperament** displays itself through the way a child manages their behaviors in daily activity; temperament is drivenby both **nature and nurture**.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. **Understands and follows expectations in the learning environment.**
   - Uses walking feet when transitioning to the library.
   - Puts the puzzle away, where it belongs, when finished.

b. **Adjusts behavior and adapts to transitions, daily routines, and unexpected events.**
   - Moves through activities independently.
   - Stays with the group and follows the teacher during a fire drill.
   - Chooses a cozy corner away from the group when needed.

c. **Chooses appropriate words and actions.**
   - Says and/or signs, “Stop, I don’t like it when you hit me.”
   - Waits their turn during a shared game or toy time.

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

Concept 1: Attachment

The child demonstrates the ability to engage in and maintain secure relationships.

Positive social relationships between adults and children develop in an environment where children feel safe and secure. When caregivers provide a secure base of physical and emotional support, children construct **secure attachments** with their caregivers which supports them in moving into deeper and more complex learning.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. **Expresses interest, curiosity, and trust with familiar adults.**
   - Child welcomes a new guest to the classroom.
   - When teacher smiles, child responds with a smile back.

b. **Seeks support from familiar adults.**
   - Asks for comfort/reassurance after a playground fall.
   - Seeks out the caregiver when they need help doing a task.

c. **Separates from familiar adult with minimal distress.**
   - Continues to paint after acknowledging a family member's departure.
   - Transitions quickly into classroom activity after family drop off.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

Concept 2: Social Interactions

The child displays positive social behavior.

A child's relationship with peers and adults reflect their ability to initiate and sustain positive and appropriate interactions while increasing their capacity to acknowledge someone else's perspective.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. **Responds when adults or other children initiate interactions.**
   - Selects from the choice board when asked, "What do you want to do now?"
   - Decides whether to join a group when invited to play.

b. **Initiates and sustains positive interactions with adults and other children.**
   - Shares about a new food at dinner.
   - Suggests, "Let's build a road for our cars." Then the children work together to build a road.

c. **Acknowledges someone's perspective by demonstrating positive ways to resolve conflict.**
   - Child asks, "When you're done, can I play with it?"
   - Seeks assistance from a teacher when a disagreement starts to escalate.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

Concept 3: Respect

The child has an increasing capacity to understand social boundaries about behavior and the environment.

When children interact with others, they become aware of the boundaries of acceptable behavior and possess a growing sense of the potential consequences of their actions. Children thrive in environments when they have a sense of ownership.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. **Respects the rights and property of others.**
   - Walks around a block structure built by another child.
   - Waits behind friend for their turn to go down the slide.

b. **Defends own rights and the rights of others.**
   - Tells his friend not to knock down his block structure.
   - Tells teacher, “I can’t have anything with peanuts.”

c. **Shows respect for learning materials in the learning environment.**
   - Stacks up books after reading time.
   - Puts caps on markers after using them.